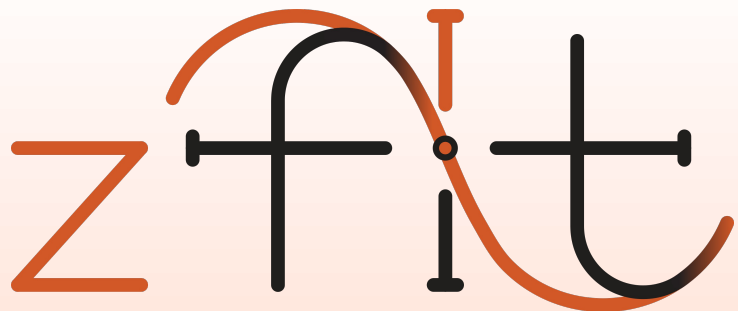




scalable pythonic  
likelihood fitting

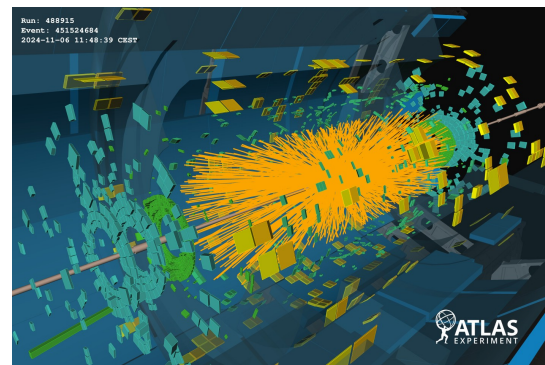
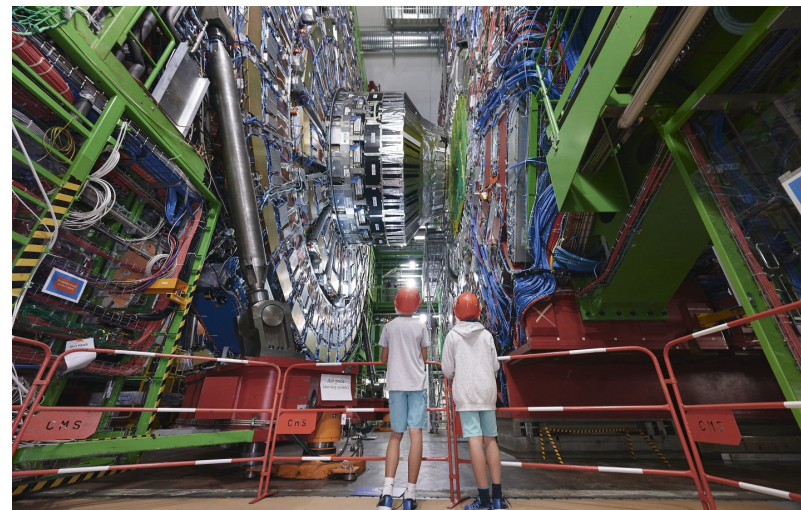
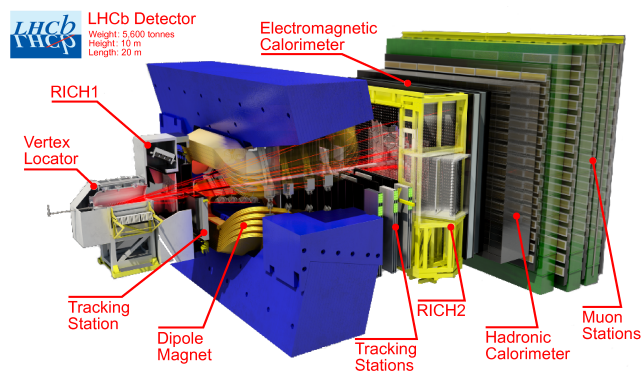
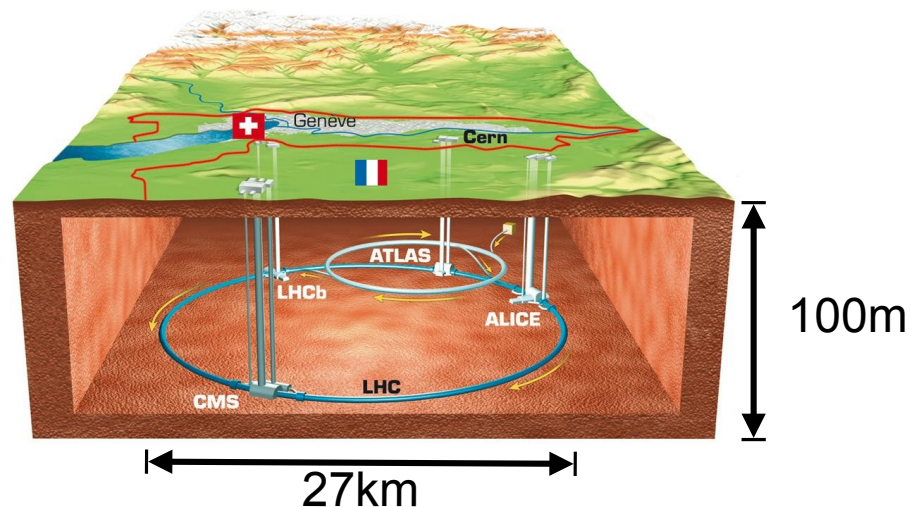
**Jonas Eschle**

`jonas.eschle@cern.ch`

*for the zfit team*

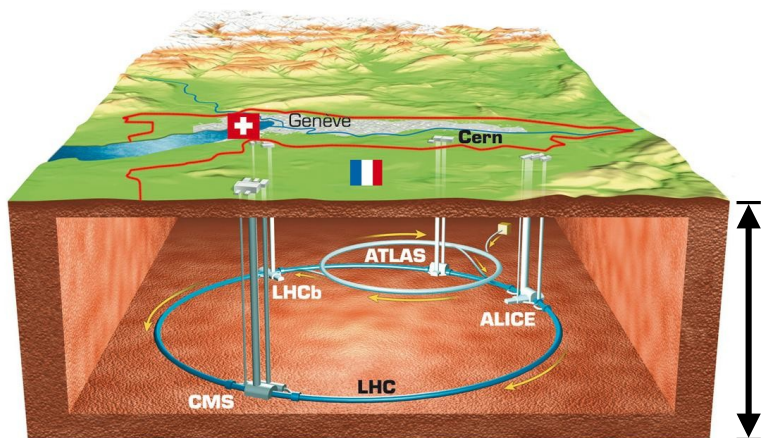


# High Energy Physics

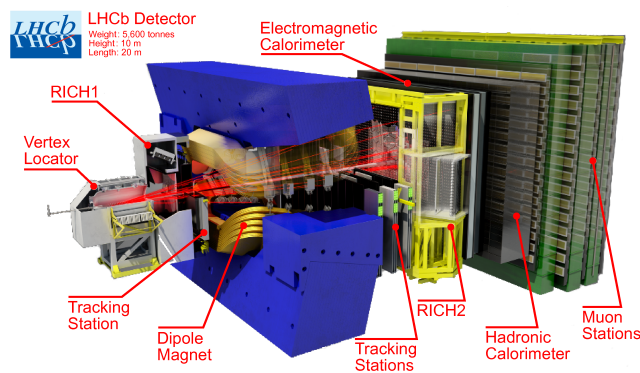


Every 25  
nano sec

# High Energy Physics

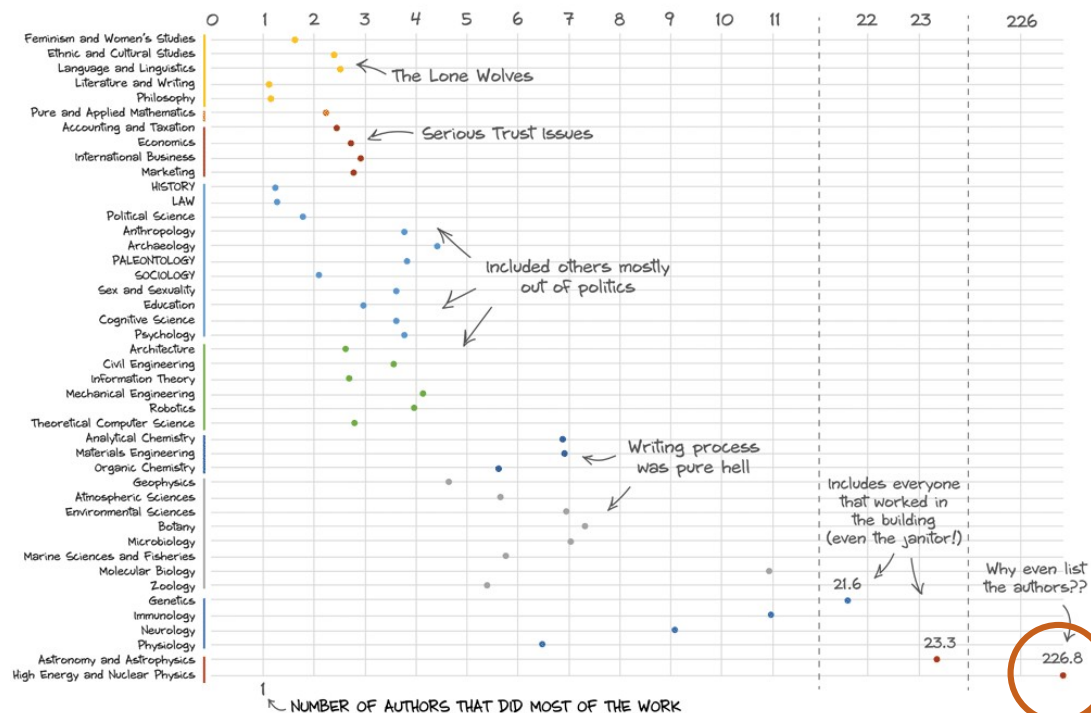


27km



## NUMBER OF LISTED AUTHORS

AVERAGE NUMBER OF AUTHORS PER PAPER BY DISCIPLINE



Adapted from the latest 100 papers in each of the two data journals.



# HEP Analysis



## ROOT: analyzing petabytes of data, scientifically.

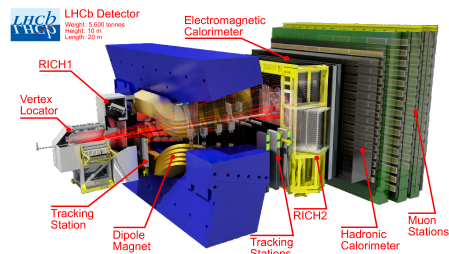
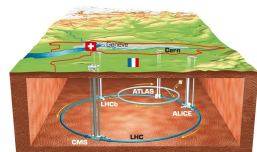
An open-source data analysis framework used by high energy physics and others.

Learn more

Install v6.36.00

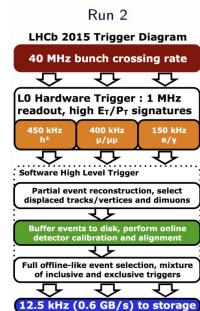


## C++ large data analysis framework (1994)



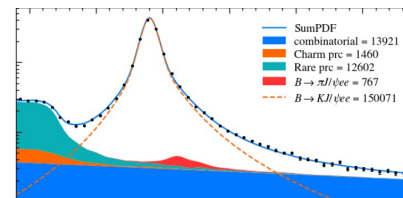
Lots of code

Terabytes per second

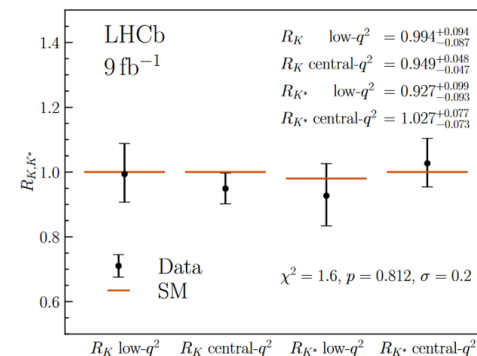


Petabytes of data

Lots of code



Lots of code



# Historic landscape



Analyses transition from C++ to Python

HEP (fitting) libraries still in C++

Good libraries  
mediocre bindings  
not «pythonic»

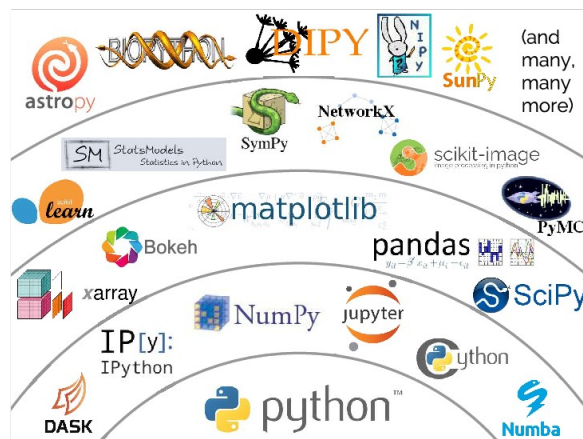
2016



# Leveraging Python

## Analyses transition from C++ to Python

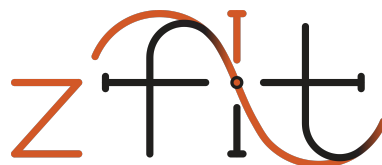
Provides a lot of functionality  
pandas, scipy & friends



2016

Missing:

- domain specific packages  
particle data, plotting styles,...
- fundamentals for big data  
histograms, fitting, jagged arrays



# **Likelihood fitting in High Energy Physics**

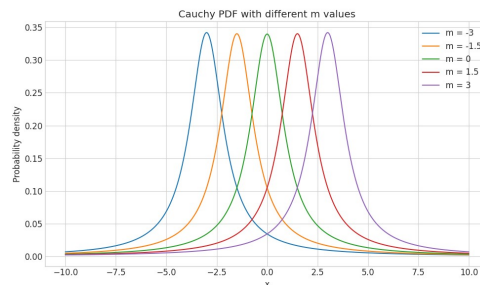
# Likelihood-like fitting

$p(\Omega) = 1$ : The probability over the whole sample space  $\Omega$  is 1

PDF are normalized

convert arbitrary function  $f(x)$

$$PDF_f(x) = \frac{f(x)}{\int_{\Omega} f(x) dx}$$



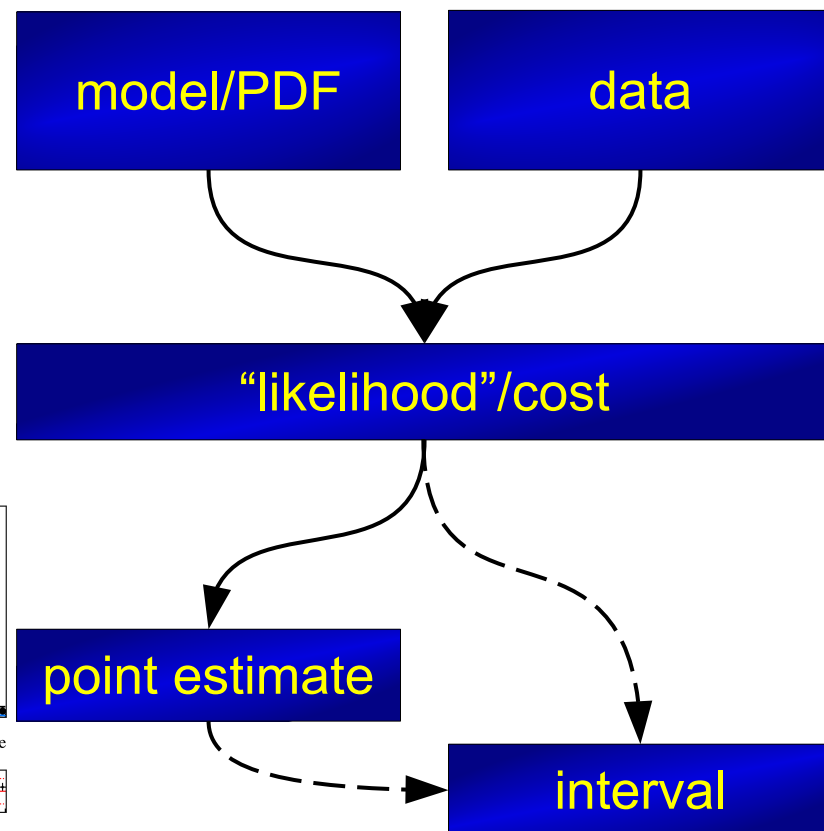
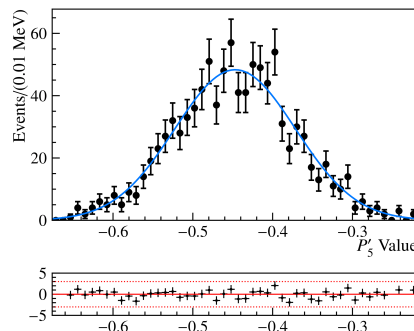
$$\mathcal{L}(\theta) = p_1(x_1; \theta_1) \cdot p_2(x_2; \theta_2) \cdot p_3(x_3; \theta_3) \dots = \prod_i^n p_i(x_i; \theta_i)$$

Maximize likelihood  $\rightarrow$  «fitting»

or minimize negative log likelihood

$$NLL(\theta) \equiv -\log \mathcal{L}(\theta) = -\sum_{i=1}^n \log p(x_i | \theta)$$

Parameter uncertainty estimation





# Different kind of fits



- **Data:** Binned vs unbinned

# Different kind of fits



- Data: Binned vs unbinned
- **Shape:** Template vs analytic

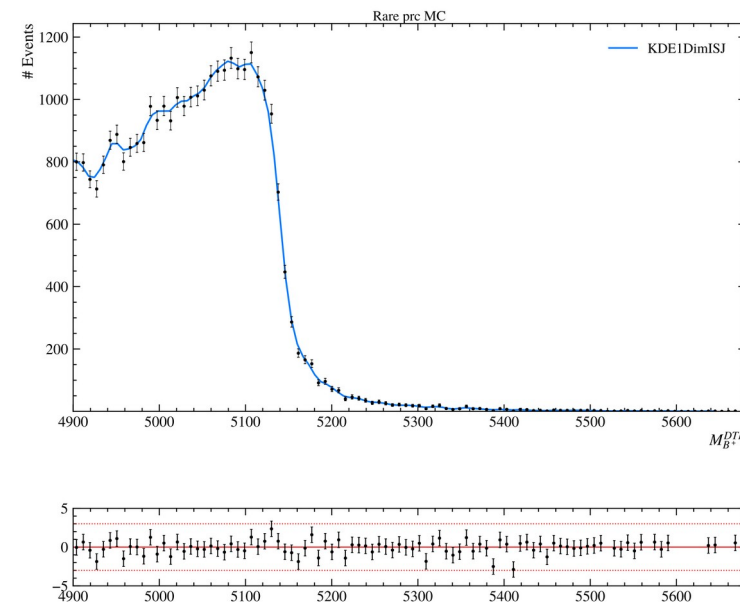
# Different kind of fits



- Data: Binned vs unbinned
- Shape: Template vs analytic
- ***Normalization: Analytical vs numerical***

# Different kind of fits

- Binned vs unbinned
- Template vs analytic
- *Analytical* vs *numerical*



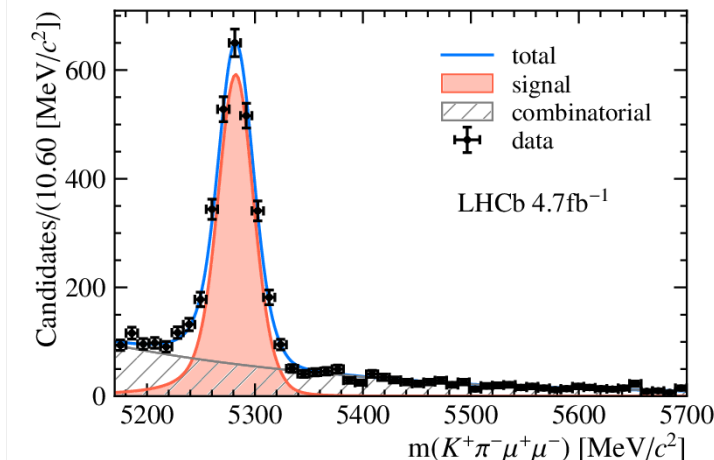
**KDE**

Gaussian kernel → analytic norm

ISJ → numeric norm

# Different kind of fits

- Binned vs unbinned
- Template vs analytic
- *Analytical* vs *numerical*



## Gauss + Exponential

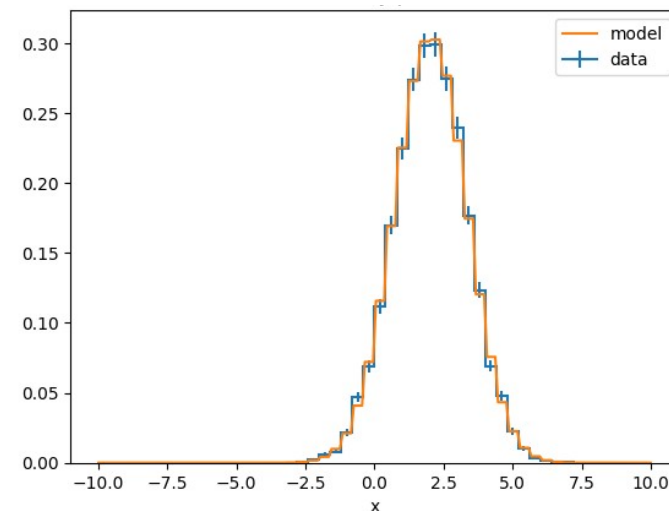
Composite model

Normalization range!  $PDF_f(x) = \frac{f(x)}{\int_{\Omega} f(x) dx}$



# Different kind of fits

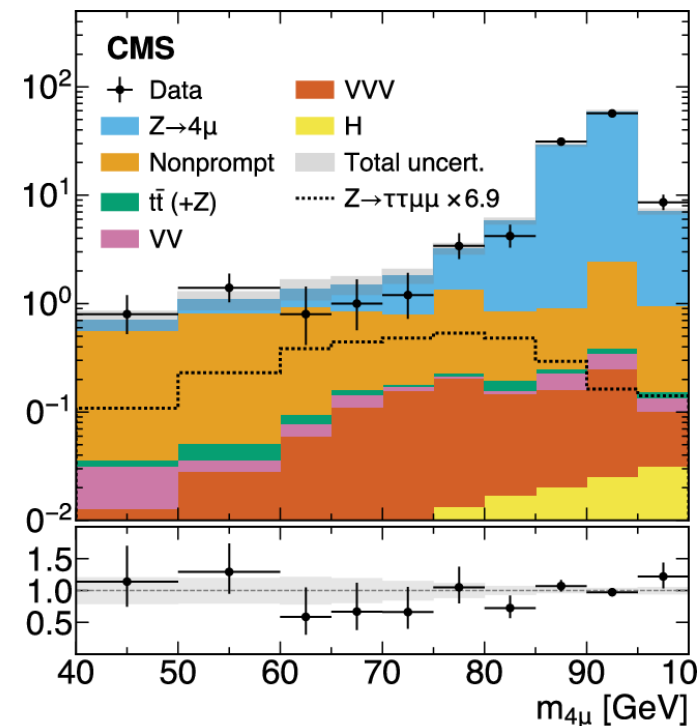
- Binned vs unbinned
- Template vs analytic
- *Analytical* vs *numerical*



**(binned) Gaussian  
fit to histogram**

# Different kind of fits

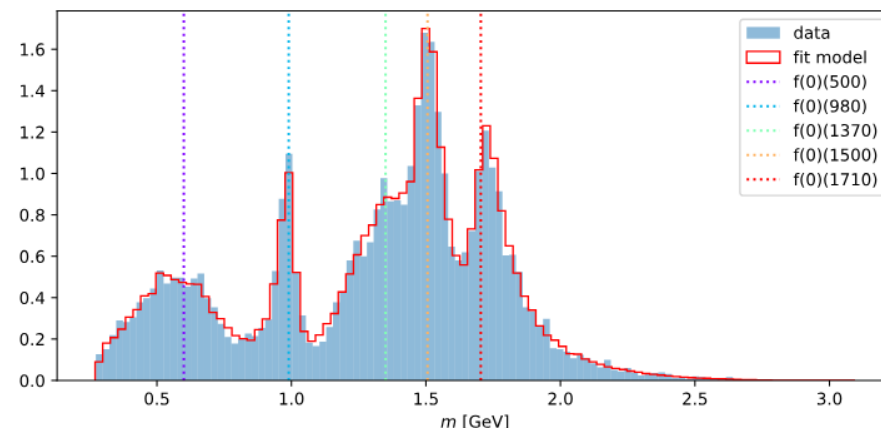
- Binned vs unbinned
- Template vs analytic
- *Analytical* vs *numerical*



**Stacked histograms PDFs**

# Different kind of fits

- Binned vs **unbinned**
- Template vs **analytic**
- Analytical vs **numerical**



**Amplitude analysis,  
Angular analysis**

*Multidimensional custom models*

Custom models, compositions don't have analytic integral

**Numerical methods** first class support

- Required for integration (normalization!), sampling
- Needs specific distribution API:
  - integrate, cannot `cdf(upper) – cdf(lower)`
  - sample, no `icdf`
  - also «needs» specific range (“cannot” integrate from `-inf` to `inf`)

$$PDF_f(x) = \frac{f(x)}{\int_{\Omega} f(x) dx}$$

# Historic landscape

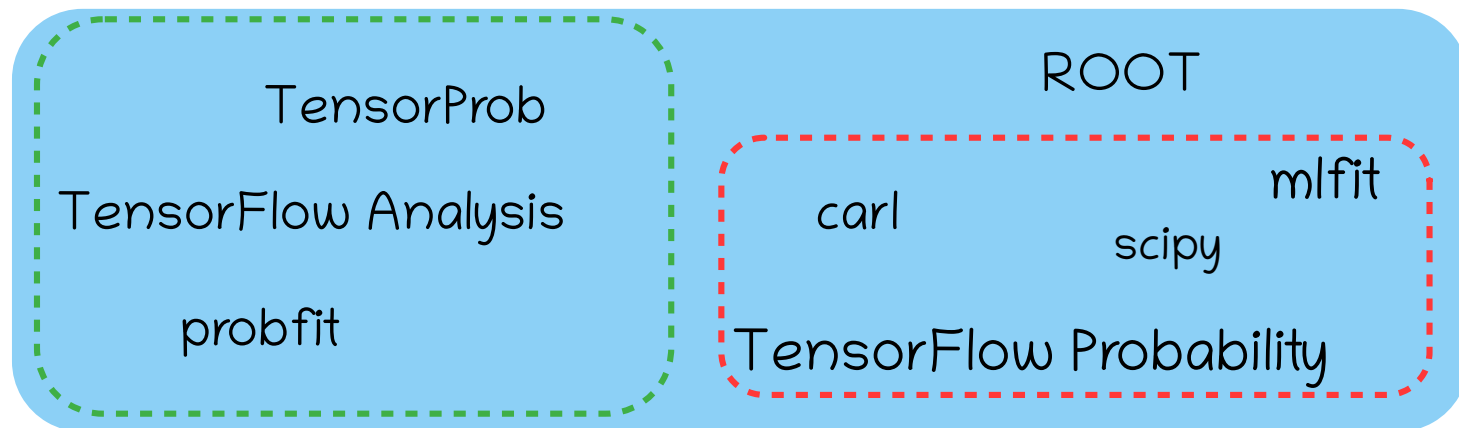
Analyses transition from C++ to Python

HEP fitting libraries still in C++

Good libraries  
mediocre bindings  
not «pythonic»

Python packages

- no advanced features
- performance needed

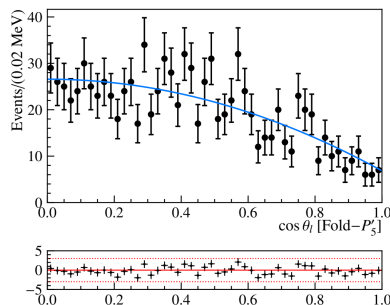


HEP Python

Non-HEP

2016

# HEP Model Fitting in Python



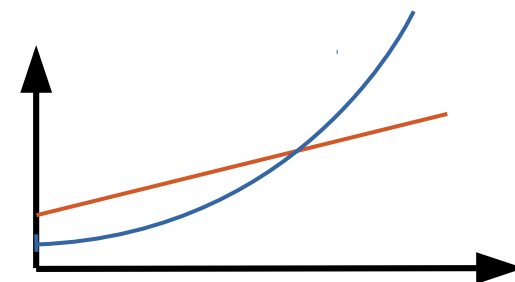
HEP

advanced features,  
simply extendable

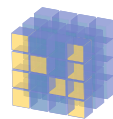


Scalable

large data, complex models



Pythonic



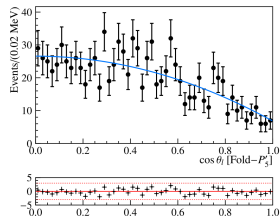
NumPy



python™

integrate into ecosystem, stable API

# HEP Model Fitting in Python



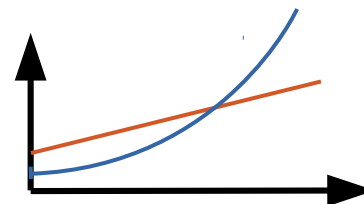
HEP

advanced features,  
simply extendable



Scalable

large data, complex models



Pythonic



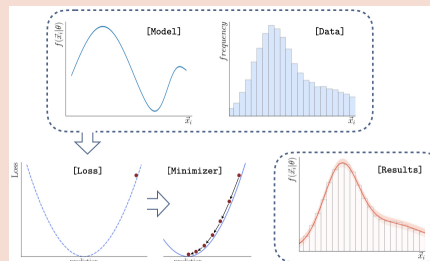
NumPy



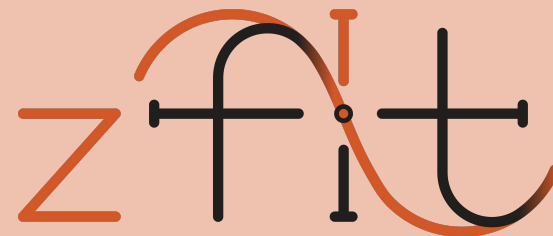
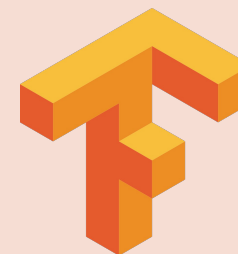
python™

integrate into ecosystem, stable API

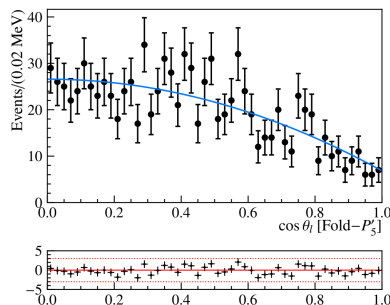
## API & Workflow



Computing  
backend



# HEP Model Fitting in Python



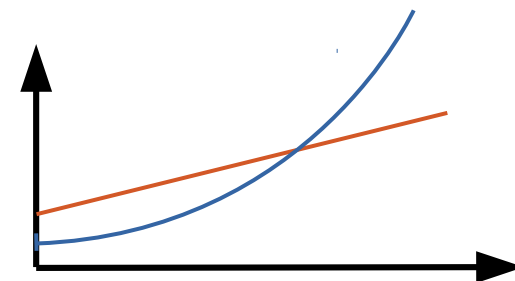
HEP

advanced features,  
simply extendable

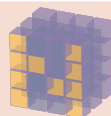


Scalable

large data, complex models



Pythonic



NumPy

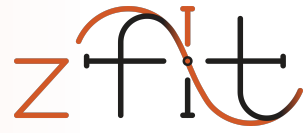


python<sup>TM</sup>

integrate into ecosystem, stable API

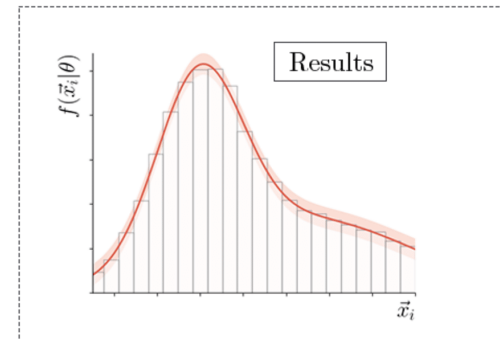
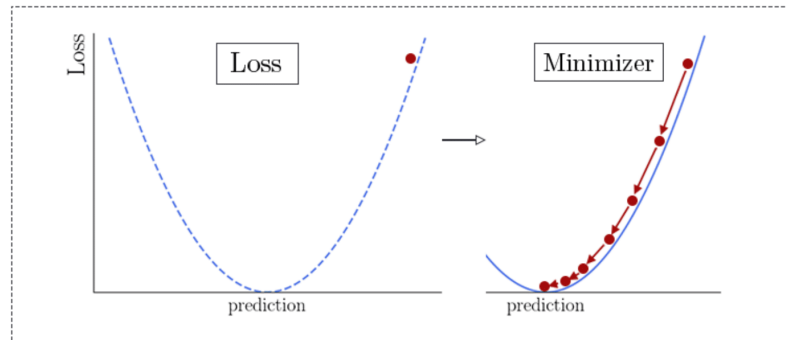
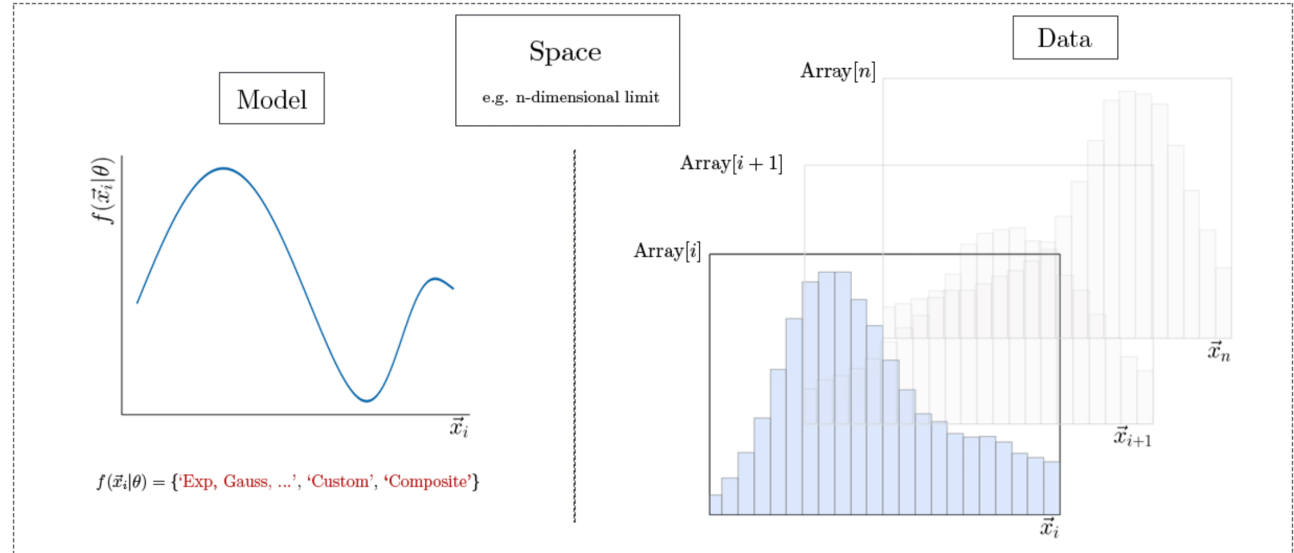


# API & Workflow



Five maximally independent parts

"Fits look always the same"



# Basic API example

```
obs = zfit.Space("x", -2, 3)

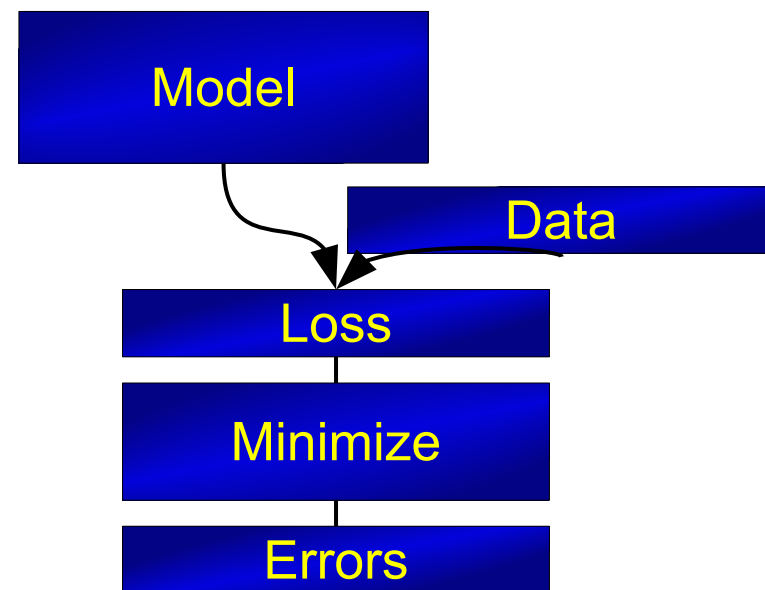
mu = zfit.Parameter("mu", 1.2, -4, 6)
sigma = zfit.Parameter("sigma", 1.3, 0.5, 10)
gauss = zfit.pdf.Gauss(mu=mu, sigma=sigma, obs=obs)

data = zfit.Data(data, obs=obs)

nll = zfit.loss.UnbinnedNLL(model=gauss, data=data)

minimizer = zfit.minimize.Minuit()
result = minimizer.minimize(nll)

param_errors = result.hesse()
param_errors_asymmetric, new_result = result.errors()
```



# Basic API example

## Going binned

```
obs = zfit.Space("x", -2, 3, binning=30)
```

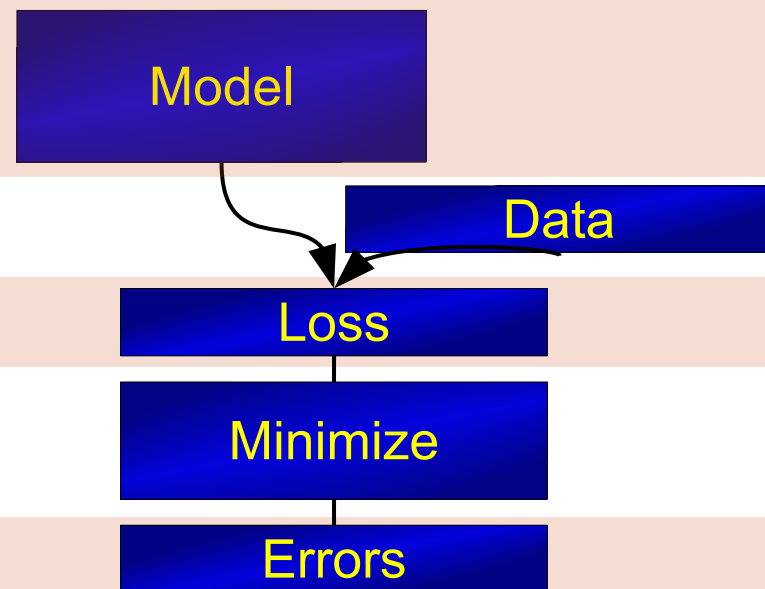
```
mu = zfit.Parameter("mu", 1.2, -4, 6)  
sigma = zfit.Parameter("sigma", 1.3, 0.5, 10)  
gauss = zfit.pdf.Gauss(mu=mu, sigma=sigma, obs=obs)
```

```
data = zfit.Data(data, obs=obs)
```

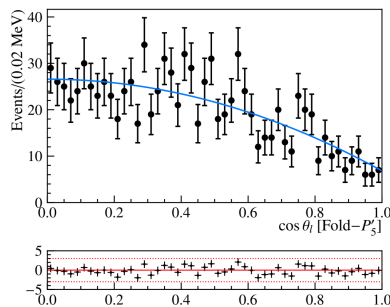
```
nll = zfit.loss.BinnedNLL(model=gauss, data=data)
```

```
minimizer = zfit.minimize.Minuit()  
result = minimizer.minimize(nll)
```

```
param_errors = result.hesse()  
param_errors_asymmetric, new_result = result.errors()
```

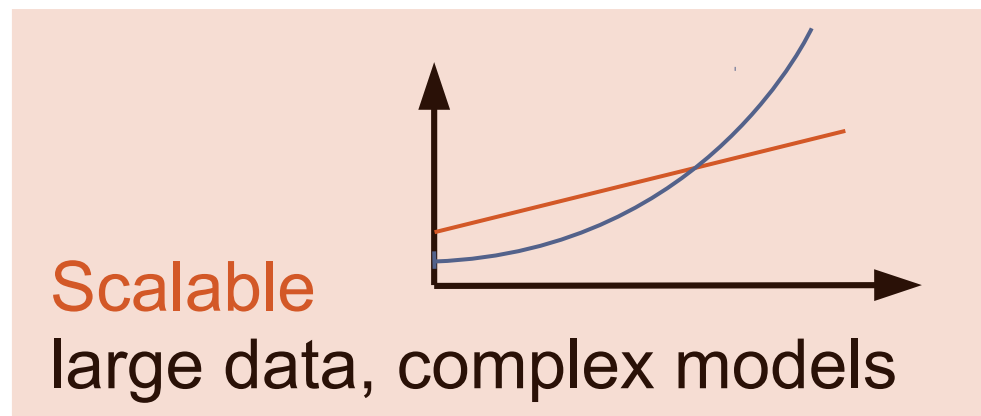


# HEP Model Fitting in Python



HEP

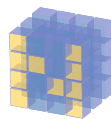
advanced features,  
simply extendable



Scalable

large data, complex models

Pythonic



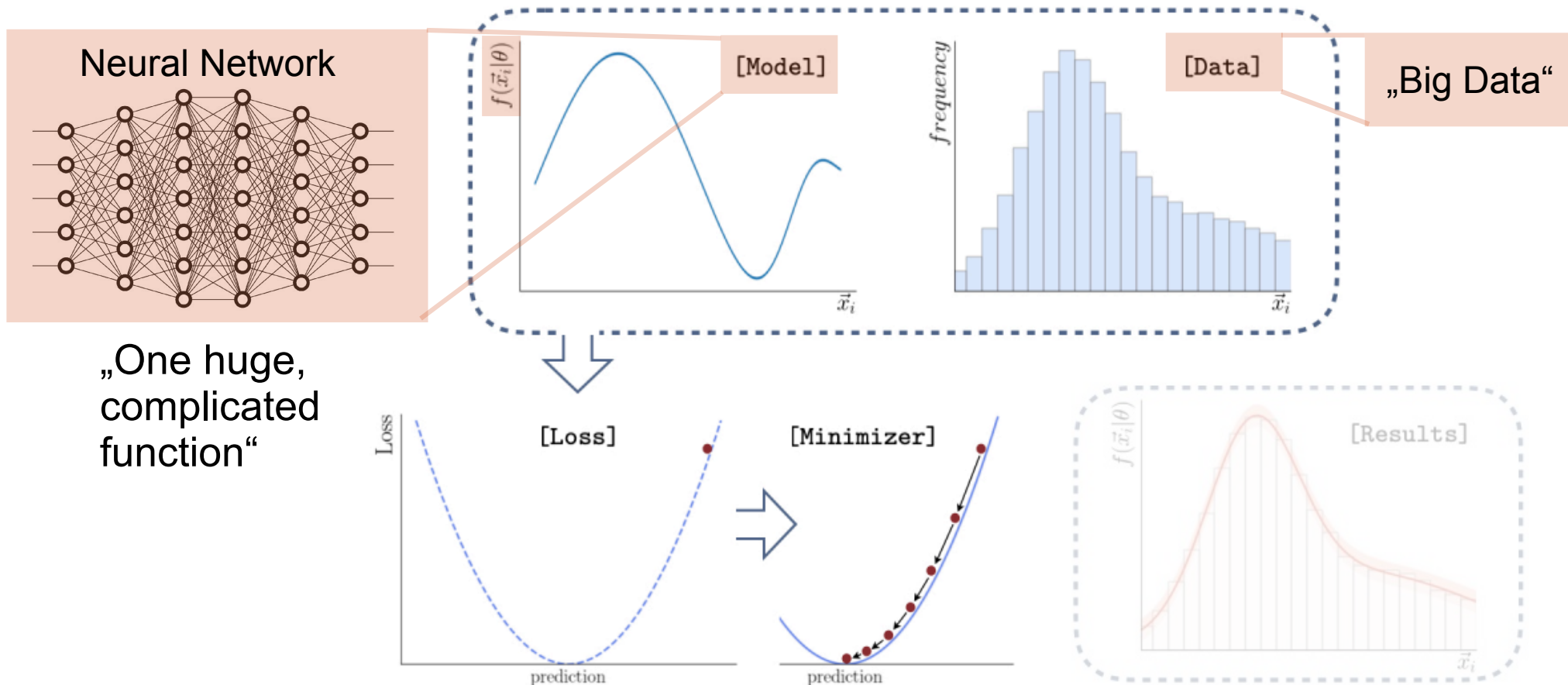
NumPy



python™

integrate into ecosystem, stable API

# Deep Learning



# Deep Learning vs. Model Fitting

| Similarity    | Complicated Models              | Large Data          | Composed loss                      | Minimization                                          | Results and uncertainties |
|---------------|---------------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| HEP           | Non-trivial functions           | Whole Dataset       | simultaneous, constraints          | Global min, 2 <sup>nd</sup> derivative algorithm      | Hesse, profiling          |
| Deep Learning | Combine many, trivial functions | Many, small Batches | <i>Anything!</i><br>(GANs, RL,...) | Local (!) min, 1 <sup>th</sup> derivative, many steps | None                      |
| Conclusion    |                                 |                     |                                    |                                                       |                           |

# Main backend: TensorFlow

- By Google, highly popular (150k★, top on )
- Consists of "two parts":
  - High level API for building neural networks (*NOT used!*)
  - **Low level API** with Numpy-style syntax  
`tf.sqrt`, `tf.random.uniform`, ... or *tnp.sqrt*, *tnp.array*, *tnp.linspace*
- Two modes:
  - "numpy"-like (full Python flexibility)
  - "compiled" (very performant)

} GPU/Multi CPU support



# JIT compilation



- 1) Function is called with arguments (array-like)
- 2) Function is ***traced with symbolic arrays***
  - Python code is executed
  - Only TF functions remembered
  - Cache compiled code with signature
- 3) Execute compiled code with inputs
- 4) Repeated calls: only step 1) and 3)

```
@tf.function(autograph=False)
def add_mult(a, b, c, d):
    print("compiling...")
    tf.print("running")
    sum_ab = a + b
    sum_cd = c + d
    return sum_ab * sum_cd
```

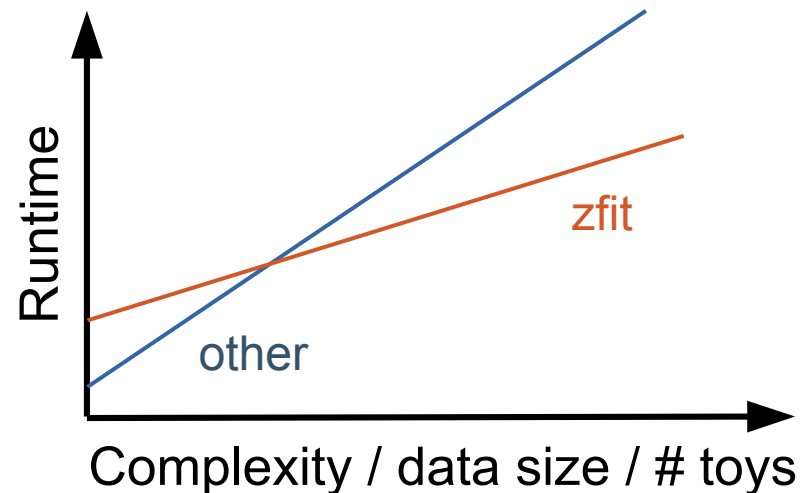
|      |   |                  |
|------|---|------------------|
| slow | { | add_mult(...)    |
|      |   | # "compiling..." |
|      |   | # "running"      |
| fast | { | add_mult(...)    |
|      |   | # "running"      |



# Scalable: Performance

## *Use same backend as ML uses*

- Numpy-like backend TF (JAX, ...)
  - JIT compiled
  - CPU and GPU
  - Automatic gradient
- Initial overhead, flat increase



## Single, simple fit "slow"

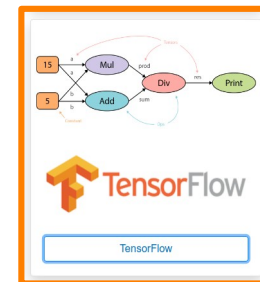
- 0.01 or 1 sec not relevant
- 1 or 10 hours relevant

```
import zfit.z.numpy as znp
```

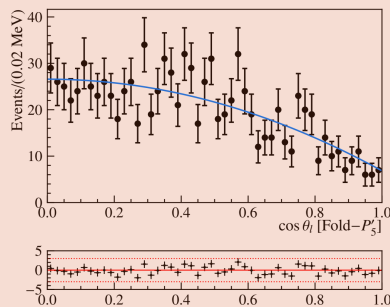
```
ar = znp.linspace(0, 1, 10)
```

```
sin = znp.sin(ar)
```

```
sum_sin = znp.sum(sin)
```



# HEP Model Fitting in Python



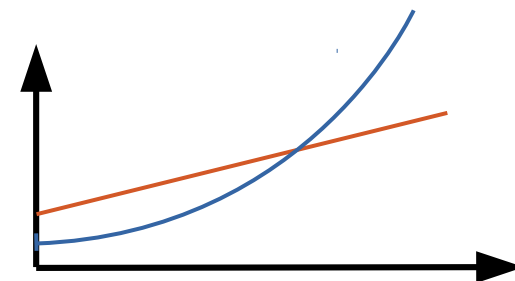
HEP

advanced features,  
simply extendable

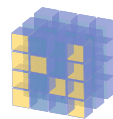


Scalable

large data, complex models



Pythonic



NumPy



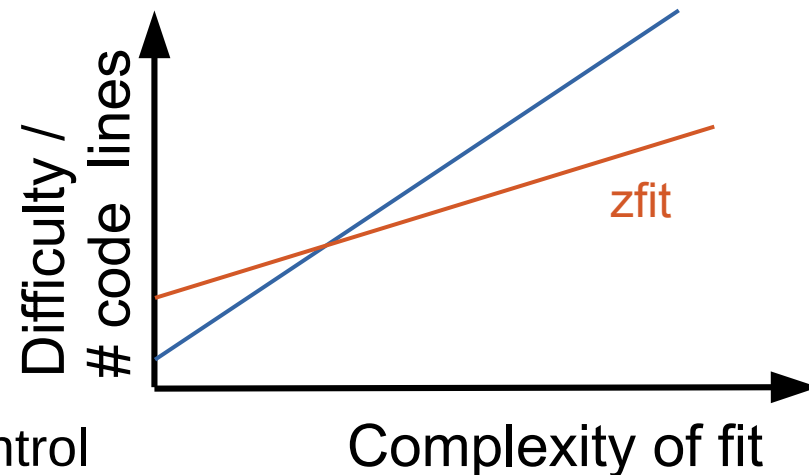
python™

integrate into ecosystem, stable API

«Things should not be easy or hard, but *consistent*»

Cover all use-cases  
out-of-the-box impossible

- Convenient base classes, allow full control
- **Modular structure**; provide all elements



# Basic API example

```
obs = zfit.Space("x", -2, 3)

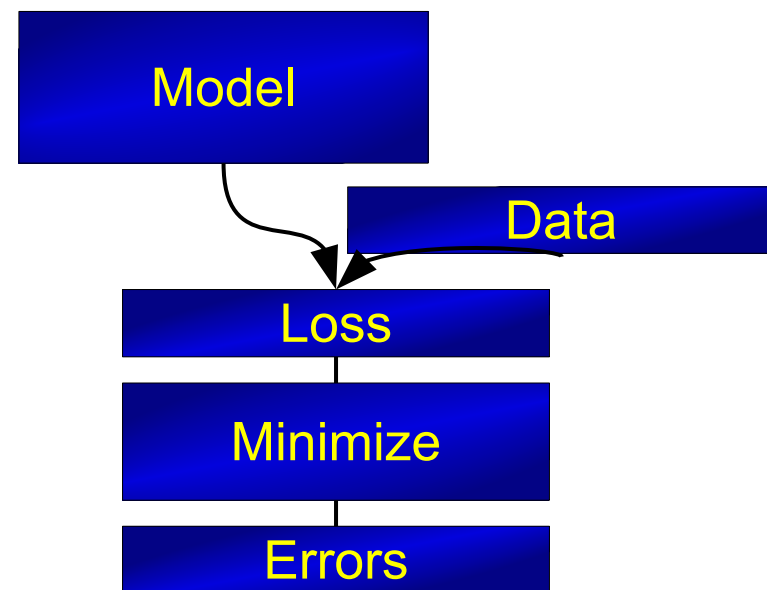
mu = zfit.Parameter("mu", 1.2, -4, 6)
sigma = zfit.Parameter("sigma", 1.3, 0.5, 10)
gauss = zfit.pdf.Gauss(mu=mu, sigma=sigma, obs=obs)

data = zfit.Data(data, obs=obs)

nll = zfit.loss.UnbinnedNLL(model=gauss, data=data)

minimizer = zfit.minimize.Minuit()
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param_errors = result.hesse()
param_errors_asymmetric, new_result = result.errors()
```



# Basic API example

```
obs = zfit.Space("x", -2, 3)

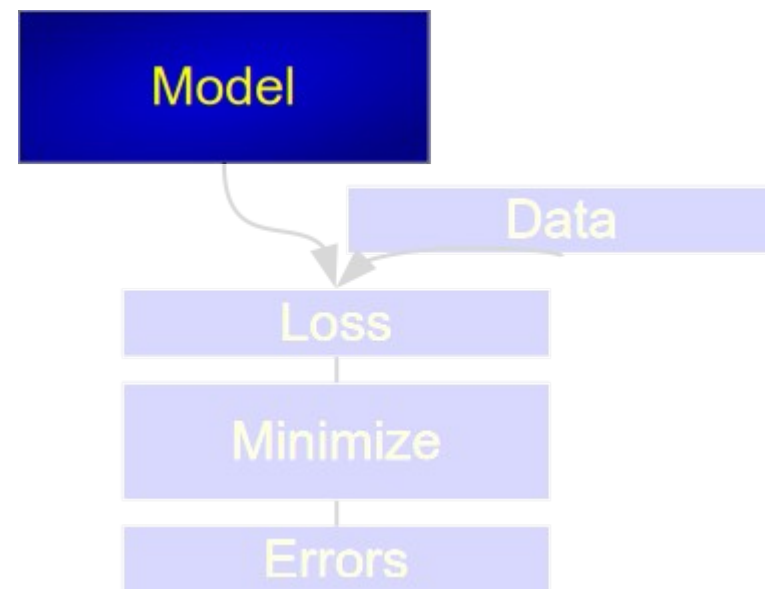
mu = zfit.Parameter("mu", 1.2, -4, 6)
sigma = zfit.Parameter("sigma", 1.3, 0.5, 10)
gauss = zfit.pdf.Gauss(mu=mu, sigma=sigma, obs=obs)

data = zfit.Data(data, obs=obs)

nll = zfit.loss.UnbinnedNLL(model=gauss, data=data)

minimizer = zfit.minimize.Minuit()
result = minimizer.minimize(nll)

param_errors = result.hesse()
param_errors_asymmetric, new_result = result.errors()
```



# Example fit

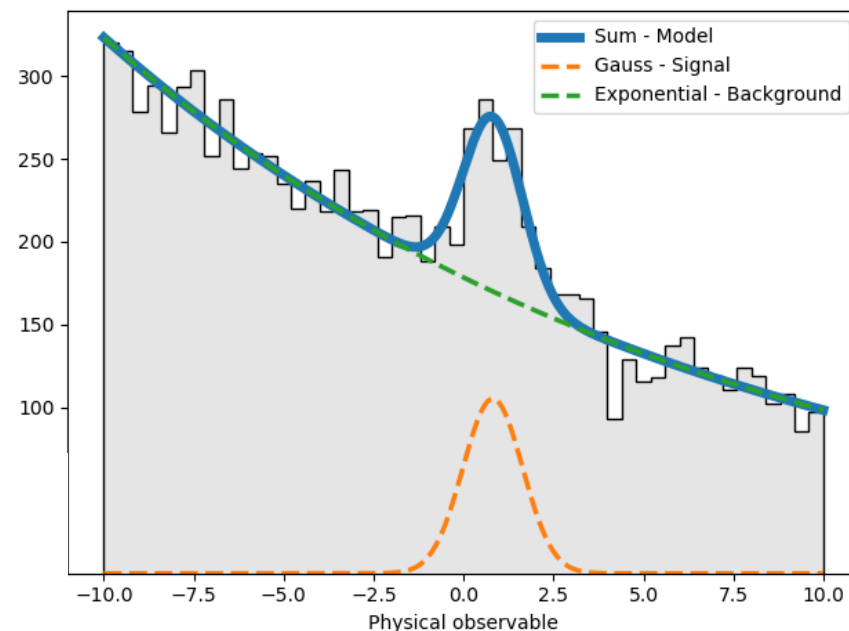
- Sum, Product, (*Convolution*)
- Gauss, (double) Crystalball,...
- Exponential, Polynomials,...
- Histograms, SplineInterpolation,...

```

lambd = zfit.Parameter("lambda", -0.06, -1, -0.01)
frac = zfit.Parameter("fraction", 0.3, 0, 1)

gauss = zfit.pdf.Gauss(mu=mu, sigma=sigma, obs=obs)
exponential = zfit.pdf.Exponential(lambd, obs=obs)
model = zfit.pdf.SumPDF([gauss, exponential], fracs=frac)

```



```
import zfit
import zfit.z.numpy as znp

class CustomPDF(zfit.pdf.ZPDF):
    _PARAMS = ("alpha",)

    @zfit.supports(norm=False)
    def _pdf(self, x, norm, params):
        data = x[0] # axis 0
        alpha = params["alpha"]
        return znp.exp(alpha * data)
```

```
custom_pdf = CustomPDF(obs=obs, alpha=0.2)
```

```
integral = custom_pdf.integrate(limits=(-1, 2))
sample   = custom_pdf.sample(n=1000)
prob     = custom_pdf.pdf(sample)
```

## Example of zfit Base Classes

Can also override:

- integrate → `_integrate`
- pdf → `_pdf`
- sample → `_sample`

Or register integral

} use functionality of model

# Arbitrary analytic shapes





PDFs TF-PWA RooFit pyhf ComPWA

## Welcome to zfit-physics

zfit-physics is a package that provides physics-related functionality to zfit. It is not a standalone package but requires [zfit](#) to be installed.

It can be installed via pip:

```
pip install zfit-physics
```

or via conda:

```
conda install -c conda-forge zfit-physics
```

## PDF documentation

PDFs

- Argus
- CMSShape
- Cruijff
- ErfExp
- Novosibirsk
- RelativisticBreitWigner
- Tsallis

For example, create amplitude with **ComPWA** and **zfit**

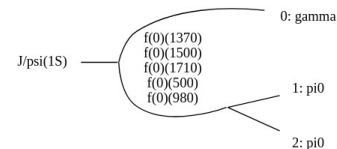
### Amplitude analysis with zfit

► Show code cell content

### Formulating the model

```
import grules
reaction = grules.generate_transitions(
    initial_state=["J/psi(1S)", [-1, +1]],
    final_state=["gamma", "pi0", "pi0"],
    allowed_intermediate_particles=["f(0)"],
    allowed_interaction_types=["strong", "EM"],
    formalism="helicity",
)
```

► Show code cell source



```
import ampform
from ampform.dynamics.builder import (
    create_non_dynamic_with_ff,
    create_relativistic_breit_wigner_with_ff,
)

model_builder = ampform.get_builder(reaction)
```



# Binned models

- Universal Histogram Interface (UHI)
- Modelled after **boost-histogram/hist/UHI**
  - Axes, names, ....



```
h = hist.Hist(hist.axis.Regular(3, -3, 3, name="x", flow=False),
              hist.axis.Regular(2, -5, 5, name="y", flow=False))
```

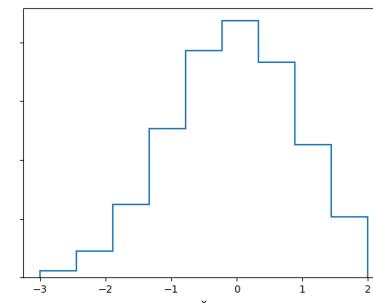
```
x = np.random.randn(1_000_000)
y = 0.5 * np.random.randn(1_000_000)
h.fill(x=x, y=y)
```

```
pdf = zfit.pdf.HistogramPDF(data=h)
```

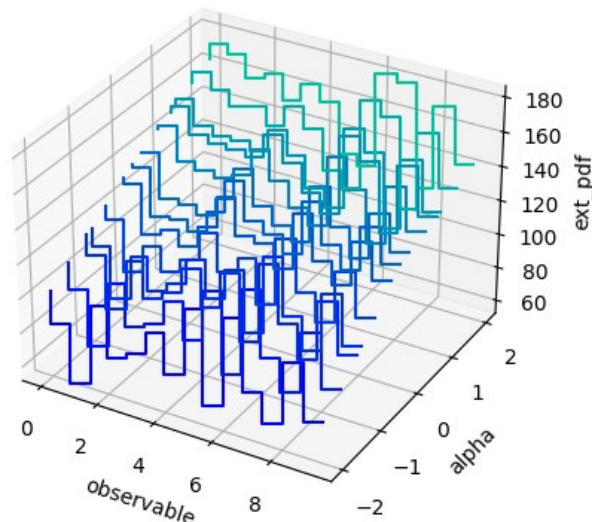
```
mplhep.histplot(h_back)
```

...and back

```
h_back = pdf.to_hist()
```

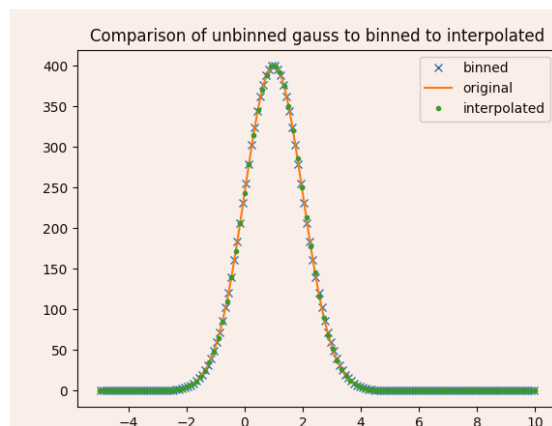


# More histograms

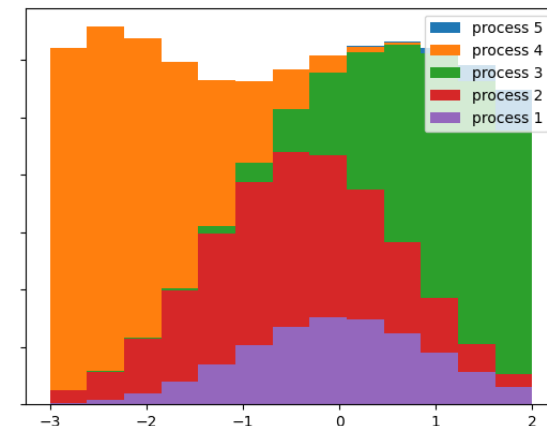


## Shape modifier

```
pdf_syst = zfit.pdf.BinwiseScaleModifier(pdf, modifiers=True)
```



Unbinned → binned → interpolated



```
pdfs = [zfit.pdf.HistogramPDF(h) for h in histos]
alpha = zfit.Parameter('alpha', 0, -5, 5)
morph = SplineMorphingPDF(alpha=alpha, hists=pdfs)
```

```
pdfs = [zfit.pdf.HistogramPDF(h) for h in histos]
sumpdf = zfit.pdf.BinnedSumPDF(pdfs)
```

# Basic API example

```
obs = zfit.Space("x", -2, 3)

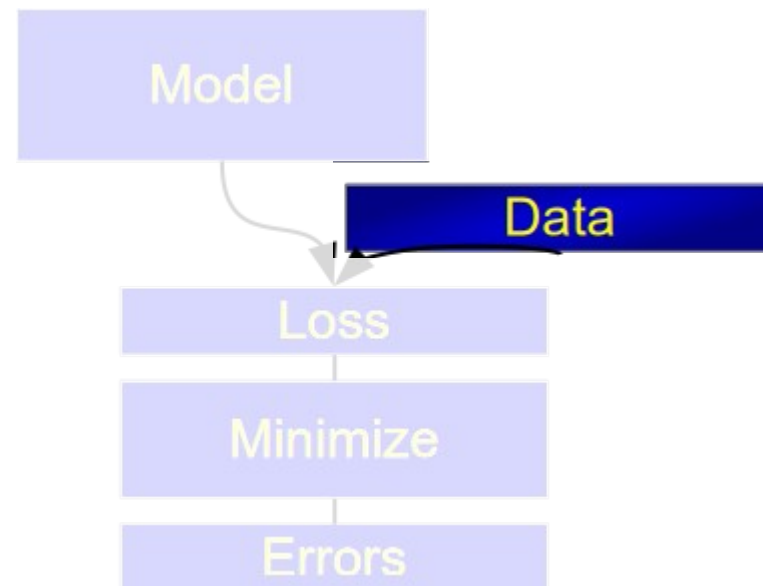
mu = zfit.Parameter("mu", 1.2, -4, 6)
sigma = zfit.Parameter("sigma", 1.3, 0.5, 10)
gauss = zfit.pdf.Gauss(mu=mu, sigma=sigma, obs=obs)

data = zfit.Data(data, obs=obs)

nll = zfit.loss.UnbinnedNLL(model=gauss, data=data)

minimizer = zfit.minimize.Minuit()
result = minimizer.minimize(nll)

param_errors = result.hesse()
param_errors_asymmetric, new_result = result.errors()
```



- From different sources
  - Hist, numpy, Pandas, ROOT, ...

Python ecosystem for  
preprocessing

- Efficiently sampled from a model

```
data = model.create_sampler(n_sample, limits=obs)
```

- UHI compatible!

```
binneddata = binnedpdf.sample()  
mplhep.histplot(binneddata)
```

# Basic API example

```
obs = zfit.Space("x", -2, 3)

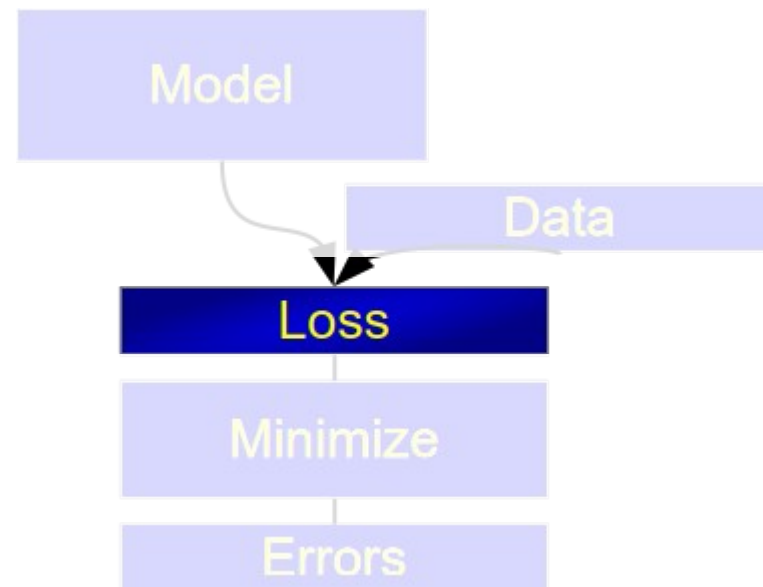
mu = zfit.Parameter("mu", 1.2, -4, 6)
sigma = zfit.Parameter("sigma", 1.3, 0.5, 10)
gauss = zfit.pdf.Gauss(mu=mu, sigma=sigma, obs=obs)

data = zfit.Data(data, obs=obs)

nll = zfit.loss.UnbinnedNLL(model=gauss, data=data)

minimizer = zfit.minimize.Minuit()
result = minimizer.minimize(nll)

param_errors = result.hesse()
param_errors_asymmetric, new_result = result.errors()
```



# Loss

```
nll1 = zfit.loss.UnbinnedNLL(model=gauss1, data=data1)
nll2 = zfit.loss.UnbinnedNLL(model=gauss2, data=data2)
nll_simultaneous2 = nll1 + nll2
```

(arbitrary) constraints supported, added to loss

```
constr = GaussianConstraint(params=params, observation=observed, uncertainty=sigma)
nll = zfit.loss.BinnedNLL(model=model, data=data, constraint=constr)
```

## Available Loss Classes:

- `zfit.loss.UnbinnedNLL`
- `zfit.loss.ExtendedUnbinnedNLL`
- `zfit.loss.BinnedNLL`
- `zfit.loss.ExtendedBinnedNLL`
- `zfit.loss.BinnedChi2`

- `zfit.loss.ExtendedBinnedNLL`
- `zfit.loss.BinnedChi2`
- `zfit.loss.ExtendedBinnedChi2`
- `zfit.loss.BaseLoss`
- `zfit.loss.SimpleLoss`

Support sample weights

# Basic API example

```
obs = zfit.Space("x", -2, 3)

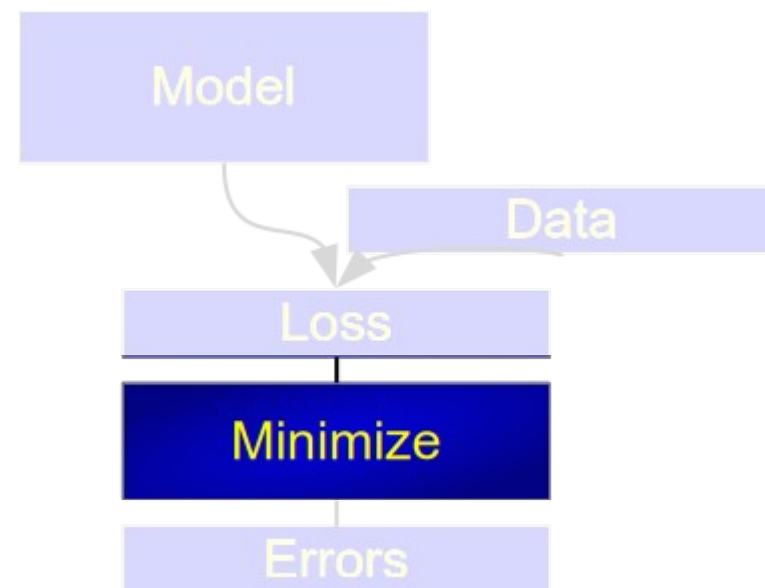
mu = zfit.Parameter("mu", 1.2, -4, 6)
sigma = zfit.Parameter("sigma", 1.3, 0.5, 10)
gauss = zfit.pdf.Gauss(mu=mu, sigma=sigma, obs=obs)

data = zfit.Data(data, obs=obs)

nll = zfit.loss.UnbinnedNLL(model=gauss, data=data)

minimizer = zfit.minimize.Minuit()
result = minimizer.minimize(nll)

param_errors = result.hesse()
param_errors_asymmetric, new_result = result.errors()
```



# Minimize

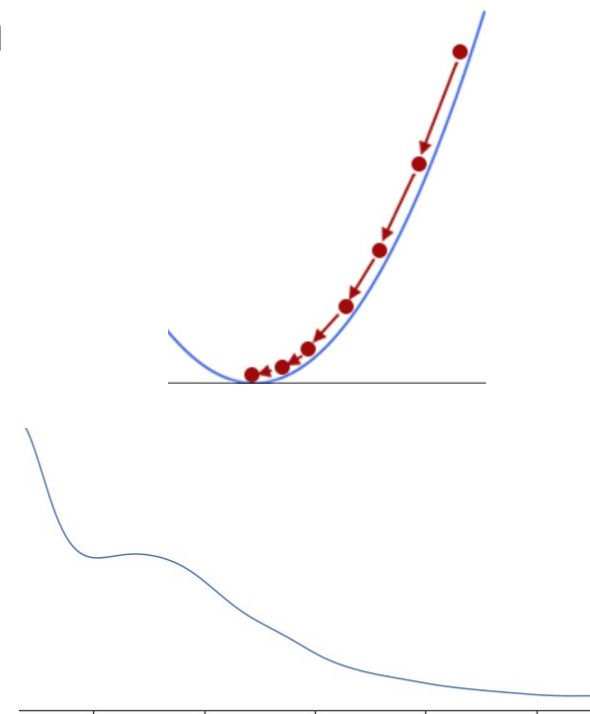
## A few, non-unified minimizer APIs in ecosystem

- Interfaces non-optimal: many invalid combinations
- Different stopping criteria: xtol, ftol, absgtol, relxtol...

### 1. Configuration: differs partially

- All have stopping criteria

### 2. Minimize: same





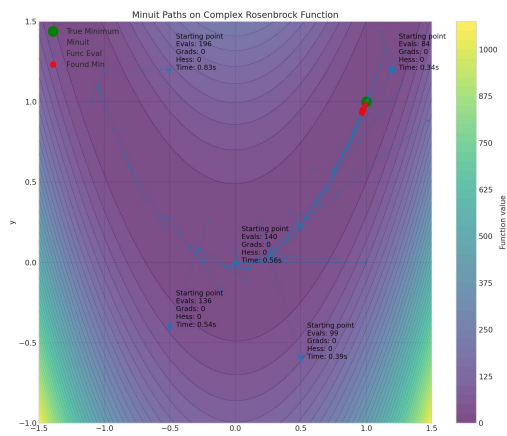
# Minimize

config: differs partially

```
minimizer = zfit.minimize.IpyoptV1()
minimizer = zfit.minimize.Minuit()
minimizer = zfit.minimize.ScipyTrustConstrV1()
minimizer = zfit.minimize.NLoptLBFGSV1()
```

minimize(...): same API

result = minimizer.minimize(func, params)



```
class zfit.minimize.EDM(tol, loss, params, name='edm')
```

Bases: [ConvergenceCriterion](#)

Estimated distance to minimum.

This criterion estimates the distance to the minimum by using

$$EDM = g^T \cdot H^{-1} \cdot g$$

with H the hessian matrix (approximation) and g the gradient.

## ScipyLBFGSB

```
class zfit.minimize.ScipyLBFGSB(tol=None, maxcor=None, maxls=None,
    verbosity=None, gradient=None, maxiter=None, criterion=None,
    strategy=None, name='SciPy L-BFGS-B ') \[source\]
```

Bases: [ScipyBaseMinimizer](#)

Local, gradient based quasi-Newton algorithm using the limited-memory BFGS approximation.

Limited-memory BFGS is an optimization algorithm in the family of quasi-Newton methods that approximates the Broyden-Fletcher-Goldfarb-Shanno algorithm (BFGS) using a limited amount of memory (or gradients, controlled by *maxcor*).

L-BFGS borrows ideas from the trust region methods while keeping the L-BFGS update of the Hessian and line search algorithms.

This implementation wraps the minimizers in [SciPy optimize](#).

### Parameters:

- **tol** ([float](#) | [None](#)) – Termination value for the convergence/stopping criterion of the algorithm in order to determine if the minimum has been found. Defaults to 1e-3.
- **maxcor** ([int](#) | [None](#)) – Maximum number of memory history to keep when using a quasi-Newton update formula such as BFGS. It is the number of gradients to “remember” from previous optimization steps: increasing it increases the memory requirements but may speed up the convergence.
- **maxls** ([int](#) | [None](#)) – Maximum number of linesearch points.
- **verbosity** ([int](#) | [None](#)) – Verbosity of the minimizer. Has to be between 0 and 10. The verbosity has the meaning:

Can use zfit loss, but also *pure Python function*

# Basic API example

```
obs = zfit.Space("x", -2, 3)

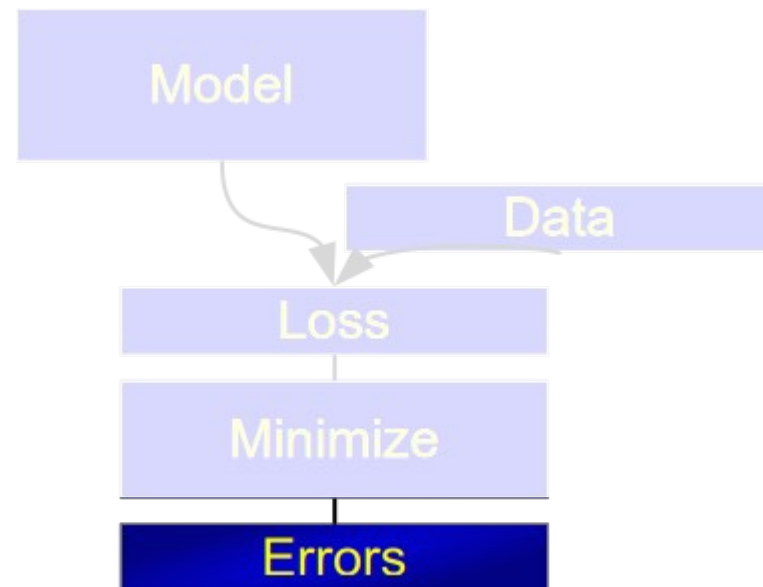
mu = zfit.Parameter("mu", 1.2, -4, 6)
sigma = zfit.Parameter("sigma", 1.3, 0.5, 10)
gauss = zfit.pdf.Gauss(mu=mu, sigma=sigma, obs=obs)

data = zfit.Data(data, obs=obs)

nll = zfit.loss.UnbinnedNLL(model=gauss, data=data)

minimizer = zfit.minimize.Minuit()
result = minimizer.minimize(nll)

param_errors = result.hesse()
param_errors_asymmetric, new_result = result.errors()
```



# Serialization

## 1) Dump/load with dill

```
result_dilled = zfit.dill.dumps(result)
result_loaded = zfit.dill.loads(result_dilled)
```

## 2) Dump/load human readable

```
model_yaml = model.to_json()
model_loaded = zfit.pdf.SumPDF.from_json(model_yaml)

hs3like = zfit.hs3.dumps(nll)
nll_loaded = zfit.hs3.loads(hs3like)
```

```
{
  'pdfs': {'SumPDF': {'pdfs': [
    {'extended': 'n_sig',
     'mu': 'mu',
     'sigma': 'sigma',
     'type': 'Gauss',
     'x': 'x'},
    {'extended': 'n_bkg',
     'lam': 'lambda',
     'type': 'Exponential',
     'x': 'x'}],
    'type': 'SumPDF'}}},
  'variables': {'lambda': {'max': -0.009999999776482582,
                           'min': -1.0,
                           'name': 'lambda',
                           'step_size': 0.001,
                           'value': -0.06294756382703781}}
```

# zfit-tutorials



Search

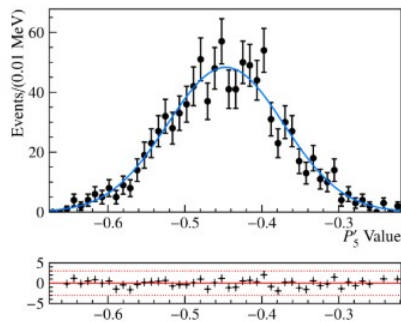
Ctrl + K

Introduction

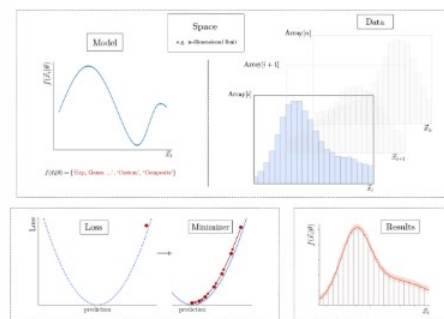
Components

Guides

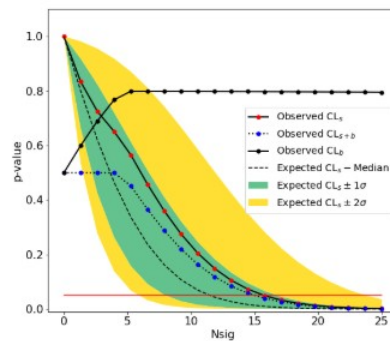
HPC with TensorFlow



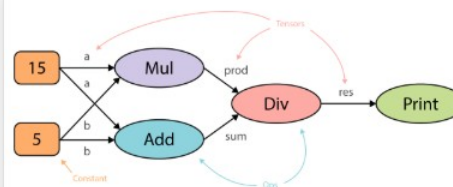
Introduction



Components



Guides



TensorFlow

# Conclusion



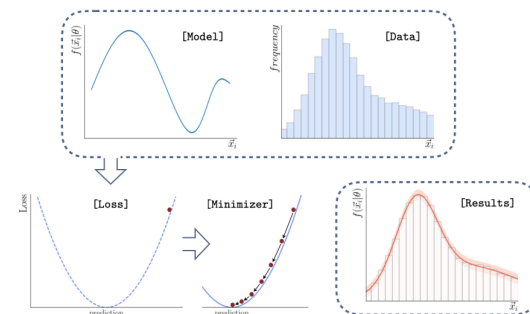
General likelihood fitter for complicated models with numerical support

Well integrated with the Python ecosystem

JIT compiled, autograd, GPU support

*Approaching 1.0 release*

*Future plans: JAX based rewrite of major components*



|                             | C++ library | Numpy based | zfit           |
|-----------------------------|-------------|-------------|----------------|
| HEP specific content/API    |             |             |                |
| Models                      |             | SciPy       | TF Probability |
| Gradients                   | CLAD        |             |                |
| Computational optimizations |             | Numba       | TensorFlow     |
| Parallelization/GPU         |             |             | nvidia         |
| Low level handling          |             |             | python         |